

CHAPTER 4

Determinants and Motivations to Travel and Tourism

3.1. The Concept of Tourism Demand:

Activity 1: Can you mention some of the factors that influencing the growth of tourism?

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Tourism demand can be defined as —the total number of persons who travel, or wish to travel, to use tourist facilities and services at places away from their places of work and residence.¶

This definition implies a wide range of influences, in addition to price and income, as determinants of demand and includes not only those who actually participate in tourism, but also those who wish to travel to, but for some reasons, do not.

Demand for tourism consists of a number of components. Effective or actual demand comprises the actual number of participants in tourism. This is the component of demand most commonly and easily measured and bulk of tourist statistics refer to effective demand. Suppressed demand is made up of that section of population who does not travel for some reasons.

Two elements of suppressed demand can be distinguished. Firstly, Potential demand refers to those who will travel at some future date if, for example, purchasing power increases or other relevant social changes take place. Second is deferred demand. It is a demand postponed because of the scarcity of the goods or services (e.g. Travel opportunities). In other words, both deferred demand potential demand may be converted into effective demand at some future date. Finally, there will always be those who simply do not wish to travel, constituting a category of —No demand¶.

Determinants of tourism demand: It represents —the parameter of possibility for the individual¶.

A) Effective demand:

2. Travel propensity: In tourism, a useful measure of effective demand is travel propensity, meaning the percentage of population who actually engage in tourism or take up travel. A high travel propensity would be expected for developed western economy with a high degree of urbanization, high income, small household sizes, and high level of mobility. Conversely, low travel propensity would be expected for rural societies with a large house hold sizes and low income.

There are also a number of factors, which will determine the propensity of a population to travel to particular destinations. These include:

- A. Economic distance: It relates to the time and cost of reaching a destination.
- B. Cultural distance: It refers to the difference in culture between the origin area and destination.
- C. Cost at the destination: Cost at a destination is not an absolute quantity, but have to be considered relative to the value of the travel's own currency.

Broadly, travel propensity for a particular population will increase with characteristics such as:

- D. Income
- E. Level of urbanization
- F. Education level
- G. Mobility level

However, it will decrease with the characteristics such as:

- H. Large house hold size
- I. Increasing age
- J. Low income

Determinants of tourism can be arranged in two levels. On the world scale, those countries with a high level of economic development and a stable urbanized population are major generators of tourism demand.

The political regime of the country is also relevant here. On the individual scale, a certain level of discretionary income is required to allow participation in tourism, and this income, and indeed the type of participation will be influenced by the factors such as job type, life cycle stage, mobility, level of education attainment and personality. Even within the developed world, many are unable to participate in tourism for same reasons. Demand for tourism is therefore not only concentrated in developed western countries but also predominates among those with high discretionary incomes.

- 3. The Personal View: Demand at the personal level- once a decision has been taken to travel, the ability to undertake the trip, and the nature of that trip will be influenced by a wide range of interrelated factors. These can be broadly classifies as:
 - A. Life style factors – These includes income, employment, holiday entitlement, education attainment and mobility.
 - B. Life cycle factors – The age and domestic circumstances of an individual affect the amount and type of tourism demanded.

Additionally personality factors, attitudes, perception and motivation will influence travel decisions.

4. The World View: When individual purchasing patterns and the influence upon them are aggregated to the national level, it is possible to gain a clearer view as to the influence upon global patterns of demand for tourism. These influences are as follows:
- A. Stage in economic development: A society's level of economic development is a major determinant affecting the size and type of tourism demand. The economy influences many critical and interrelated factors. Tourism is a result of industrialization and the more highly developed an economy, the greater the level of tourism demand.
 - B. Demographic population factors: Levels of populations, distribution. Development and density affects travel propensity. The concentration of the population in cities has an effect on tourism demand, creating a tourism and leisure hinterland around the city.
 - C. Political influences: The level of political environment will vary in both democratic to totalitarian nations. This involvement may be through encouragement in providing 'social tourism' or promotion. Alternatively, currency controls may deter people from traveling abroad; these are more common in communist countries. Generally, political instability may prevent domestic travel and discourage inbound visitors.
 - D. Pattern of tourism demand and technological influences: In Europe, international travel is fairly high as reaching other countries is easy due to their proximity, whilst in the USA, a range of tourist destinations are available domestically. Technology also acts to increase access to tourism by lowering the cost or by making product more accessible. Examples here include development in 'recreational technologies', such as wind surfers' durable outdoors clothing, heliskiing, and off road recreational vehicles.

B) Suppressed demand: The main reason why people do not travel can be identified as:

- Travel is an expensive activity.
- Lack of time
- Physical limitations (such as health)
- Family circumstances (care of elders, children studies)
- Lack of interest/fear
 - Government restrictions (currency controls, VISA) Lack of awareness (promotion, information, advertisement).

3.2. Determinants of Tourism Demand :

These are the decisive factors, which are responsible for the evolution of demand for tourism. These are concerned with the economic and social factors and with the influence of provider of tourist services, which stimulates the growth of tourism. When the reasons why the people wish to become tourist are considered, we are dealing with motivation.

The comprehensive list of factors influencing the growth of tourism comes from Louis Erdi (1970) of the Swiss Federal University. The list includes:

1. Greater affluence and more leisure for an increasing number of people, particularly in the developing countries.
2. The emancipation of the young, and the relatively higher wages they possess (when they have no family responsibilities), enabling them to travel.
3. Transport facilities, especially air, very much better and cheaper, and then are a high rate of car ownership.
4. An enormous growth in International business, necessitating travel.
5. Package tours allow people, not used to making their own arrangements, to travel with an easy mind, and are good value because of bulk buying of transport and hotel accommodation.
6. Relief from adverse climatic conditions in the home country may be found abroad.
7. Travel has become a status symbol.
8. Conferences and business meetings are proliferating.
9. Better education has interested a large section of public in the cultural tourism.
10. World exhibitions and Trade fairs have become very popular.
11. Publicity has become more aggressive, whetting the appetite of even the most unwilling to travel.
12. Ideological pressure groups (political, cultural, scientific, etc.) Hold more and more annual conferences.

Historically, the development of tourism can be seen to have been determined by economic and social factors (viz: disposable income, standard of living, availability of free time, age distribution, pattern of occupation) on the other hand by the providers of tourist services (viz; railway excursions, bus and coach operators, hotels, holiday camps, package tours, airlines, restaurants, promotion and publicity by tourist offices), these factors are the determinants for tourism.

4.3. Motivations for Tourism

- ❖ Tourist motivation as cited in Pearce, Morrison & Rutledge 1998 has been defined “**as the global integrating network of biological and cultural forces which gives value and direction to travel choices, behavior and experience.**”
- ❖ Travel motivation refers to the internal and external factors that drive people to travel.
- ❖ Understanding and assessing these factors assist service providers to develop the appropriate package for the tourists.
- ❖ While determinants are broader factors affecting the *possibility* of travel, motivation addresses the *why* behind the trip, with "push" factors originating from the individual and "pull" factors coming from the destination.

A. Maslow's Need Hierarchy Theory of Motivation

Maslow's theory of Motivation is based on a hierarchy of five basic needs



Characteristics of Maslow's Need Hierarchy Theory of motivation:

- ❖ One of the peculiar characteristics of this theory lies in the fact that an individual's needs move in a hierarchical order, i.e. from bottom to top.
- ❖ An individual can shift from a lower-level need to the upper level only after the former is satisfied.
- ❖ Once a given level of need is satisfied, it loses its ability to motivate the individual further.

Basic Physiological Needs: The needs which are the most basic, constitutes this category. For example hunger, sleep, thirst, etc. This concept can also be applied to the tourism industry. A tourist while undertaking travel ensures the availability of appropriate accommodation, potable water, and restaurants providing good quality food.

Safety/Security Needs: These needs protect individual from physical and emotional harm. For example, job security, the stability of income. etc. In the case of the tourism industry, destinations can attract tourists only if they provide sufficient security and hassle-free vacation experience. Thus, in case of a tourist destination safety and security could be ensured by providing assistance and ensuring repatriation of travelers in case of any emergency (Natural calamity, etc.).

Affiliation/belonging needs: The third need relates to the desire of formulating and/or building relationships with people to create a sense of belongingness. To tourists, this need is essential to become familiar with communities and to ultimately immerse in the travel experience.

Esteem Needs: After the fulfilment of affiliation and belonging needs, the fourth need arises which is, esteem needs. This includes self-respect, recognition, and attention. This phenomenon is very much evident in the tourism industry as a large part of the tourists' community, travel to boast among friends and family, and to gain higher social status..

Self-actualization Needs: This is the final need in the pyramid. It includes growth and self-fulfilment. In the context of tourism, travellers are seen to be traveling to improve a specific skill set like hiking, trekking or even undertaking activities like scuba diving, caving, etc which results in increased stamina, improving their risk-taking abilities and many more.

B. Dann's Theory of Push and Pull Factors

Dann clearly explains this theory through two different levels of socio-psychological motivation. The levels have been described in detail as follows: The first level, i.e. Push factors are the motives that drive people away from home. For example, Novelty, education etc
The second level being pull factors which are the motives that attract tourists towards a destination.

I. Push Factors:

As described above, push factors are **intrinsic** or **internal desire** or **needs** that urge people to travel.

Push factors are socio-psychological in nature as they arise from within the individuals and are associated with factors like desire for rest, leisure, recreation, spending time with family and friends or even a weekend getaway are all examples of Push factors.

II. Pull factors:

Pull factors, on the other hand are based on a **destination's attractiveness**, specifically the facilities and amenities it has to offer to the tourists, for example appropriate accommodation, restaurants, entertainment facilities, etc.

On the whole, both push and pull coincide for the ultimate travel decision and experience.

Push factors	Pull Factors
• Escape • Self Discovery • Leisure • Adrenaline rush • Spending time with family and friends	• Natural Beauty • Cultural attractions • Accomodation • F&B services • Recreation Facilities

C. Gray's Travel Motivation Theory

Gray's Travel motivation theory constitutes two main motives for travel:

I. Wanderlust.

Wanderlust is a strong desire or urge to travel. It is fundamentally a connate trait i.e. arising from within the individual and may be induced by socio-psychological imbalances. One of the peculiar characteristics of wanderlust is the desire to explore the undiscovered places; to leave from a familiar environment to an unfamiliar one. Curiosity also plays an important role here.

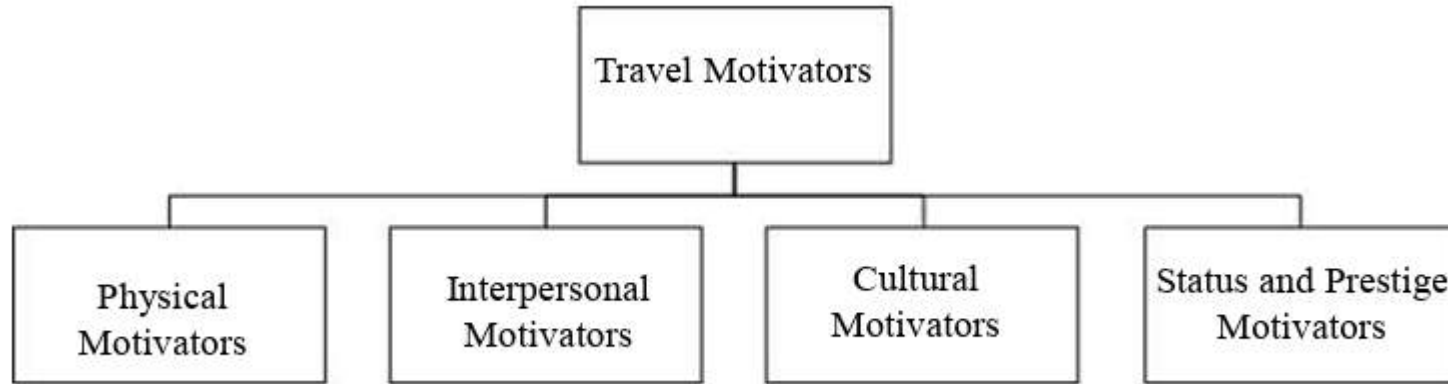
II. Sunlust

is related to travel for particular facilities or amenities that do not exist at the place of residence of the tourist. For example, recreation and leisure facilities, shopping, gaming arenas, cultural or historical interest and many more. Sun-lust also includes travel for adventure activities like trekking, rafting, mountaineering etc. The duration of this travel is of longer term as compared to wanderlust.

D. McIntosh and Goeldner Categorisation of Travel Motivation

McIntosh and Goeldner (1984) in their theory have summarized all the former studies on travel motivation.

They have broadly classified tourist groups into four categories:



I. Physical Motivators: Physical motivators are concerned with health and well-being. It includes rest, sports and recreational activities like climbing, hiking, swimming, undergoing treatments, attending yoga camps etc. In short, they are directly related to one's health.

II. Interpersonal Motivators: Human beings are complex social animals that have the ability to exchange ideas, thoughts and values through language or other means of communication. Thus, interpersonal motivators include visiting friends and relatives, spending time with family etc.

III. Cultural Motivators: The ardent desire to explore ideas, customs or social behavior of another community or society fall under this category. For instance, tourists interacting with local community and learning about their dance forms, folk lore, history etc.

IV. Status and Prestige Motivators: The need for fame, recognition, respect amongst peers and society, self-fulfillment, ego enhancement, personal development and desire for continuation of education are covered under this category. It also includes travel for business or professional purposes.

E. IsoAhola's Motivation Theory

Iso-Ahola's theory states seeking (Inherent rewards) and escaping (from routine/familiar environments) motivates people to travel.

Iso-Ahola suggested that tourists tend to keep away from extreme situations like over-stimulation(mental or physical fatigue) and very little stimulation (boredom) and looking out for internal rewards and getting away from mundane routines.

Stanley Plog (1974) identified two opposite types of tourist each at the end of a continuum.

- (1) Allocentric:** - are tourists who seek adventure on their holidays and are prepared to take risks. They prefer holidays in more exotic locations. These peoples are interested for discovering new things and destinations. Prefer to travel independently and are more of adventurers and explorers.
- (2) Psycho centric:** - on holiday this peoples are not adventurous, but prefer locations that are similar to their home environment. Such tourists may reputedly return to the same destination where they have experienced a satisfying holiday.
- (3) Midcentric:** - these types of tourists exist between allocentric and psycho centric tourists. The majorities of the population go to know destinations but do not go for exploration and adventure.
They may travel to destinations previously 'found' and made popular by allocentrics.